

KORE.AI COMPETITIVE INTELLIGENCE

Competitive Signal Report

Topic: Enterprise agentic AI & contact-center AI (CCAI) · Window: last 72h · Sunday, 28 June 2026 · 20:51 IST
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Bottom line: Agentforce's continued pricing ambiguity and ServiceNow's reliance on external alliances for AI agents underscore the market's persistent challenges with predictable TCO and integrated governance. Meanwhile, IBM attempts to leverage a non-CX-specific analyst win, creating an opening to re-emphasize Kore.ai's leadership in core conversational AI for CX.

WHAT MATTERS THIS RUN

Three signals that matter

Agentforce's new outcome-based pricing faces immediate scrutiny

WHAT HAPPENED
(2026-06-25) Salesforce introduced a prebuilt service agent with an outcome-based pricing model, but reports immediately flagged the financial implications as "still vague" for Agentforce Help Agent deployments [CX Today](#) and [salesforcedevops.net](#). **WHAT IT MEANS FOR KORE.AI**
This reinforces Agentforce's persistent pricing unpredictability and "credit anxiety" (KB). Kore.ai's per-agent/intent/tool cost attribution and compile-time validation offer superior TCO predictability and transparency, especially as automation scales.

ServiceNow expands AI agent alliances, but governance remains a question

WHAT HAPPENED
(2026-06-26) ServiceNow and Google Cloud announced a partnership to unite AI agents for autonomous enterprise operations [HPCwire](#). **WHAT IT MEANS FOR KORE.AI**
While ServiceNow is building alliances, their "assists consumption" model and ITSM-centric lock-in (KB) create TCO unpredictability. Kore.ai's ABL provides deterministic execution and compile-time validation for governance, especially critical in complex, cross-platform agent orchestration.

IBM attempts to leverage a non-CX Gartner MQ Leader placement

WHAT HAPPENED
(2026-06-25) IBM announced its recognition as a Leader in the 2026 Gartner Magic Quadrant for AI Platforms for Data Science and Machine Learning Platforms IBM. **WHAT IT MEANS FOR KORE.AI**
This is a classic misdirection. IBM remains a Gartner Challenger in the *Conversational AI Platforms* MQ (KB), which is directly relevant to CX. Kore.ai is a Leader in the CX-specific Conversational AI MQs, highlighting IBM's weakness in our core market.

AT A GLANCE

Signal priority table

Competitor	Move (dated)	Threat	Kore.ai counter
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Agentforce (Salesforce)	(2026-06-25) Introduced prebuilt service agent with outcome-based pricing, but financial clarity remains "vague" — CX Today / salesforcedevops.net	High	TCO predictability and transparent cost attribution via ABL
ServiceNow Agent Platform	(2026-06-26) Partnered with Google Cloud for autonomous enterprise AI agents — HPCwire	Med	ABL's deterministic execution and compile-time validation for governance
IBM Agent Platform	(2026-06-25) Named a Leader in Gartner MQ for AI Platforms for Data Science and Machine Learning Platforms — IBM	Low	Kore.ai is a Leader in CX-specific Conversational AI MQs where IBM is a Challenger
Parloa	(2026-06-25) Survey finds over half of Americans actively avoid chatbots — NewsBytes	Low	ABL's deterministic execution and multi-model tiering build trust and higher containment
Five9	(2026-06-26) Study finds human touch key to AI trust — MarTech Cube	Low	Seamless human agent handoff and agent-assist balance automation with human touch

ON THE RADAR

Watch for

- ServiceNow's "pricing deadline" (July 1, 2026 for old SKUs) could trigger new customer reactions or further pricing adjustments.
- Agentforce's push for one-day POCs may indicate a strategy to overcome existing pricing/complexity concerns and accelerate adoption.

SO WHAT — DO THIS NOW

Recommended actions

- Arm sales teams with clear messaging on Kore.ai's TCO predictability and transparent cost attribution, contrasting it with Agentforce's vague outcome-based pricing.
- Highlight Kore.ai's compile-time validation and deterministic execution (ABL) as a superior governance model for complex, cross-platform agentic workflows compared to ServiceNow's alliance-driven approach.
- Educate prospects and analysts on the critical distinction between general AI platform MQs and CX-specific Conversational AI MQs, leveraging Kore.ai's Leader status where IBM is a Challenger.
- Emphasize Kore.ai's ability to build trusted, effective agents that address customer skepticism (e.g., chatbot avoidance), by showcasing our platform's reliability and seamless human escalation.

EVIDENCE TRAIL

Sources

- (2026-06-28) ServiceNow Stages a 10% Rebound as AI Alliances and Pricing Deadline Rewrite the Narrative - [Ad-hoc-news.de](#)
- (2026-06-26) ServiceNow and Google Cloud Unite AI Agents for Autonomous Enterprise Operations - [HPCwire](#)
- (2026-06-27) 5 Reasons a One-Day Agentforce Operations POC Is Worth Your Time - [Salesforce](#)
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- (2026-06-25) Salesforce Introduces Prebuilt Service Agent With Outcome-Based Pricing Model - [CX Today](#)
- (2026-06-26) Five9 Study Finds Human Touch Key to AI Trust - [MarTech Cube](#)
- (2026-06-25) Parloa survey finds over half of Americans actively avoid chatbots - [NewsBytes](#)
- (2026-06-25) IBM named a Leader in the 2026 Gartner® Magic Quadrant™ AI Platforms for Data Science and Machine Learning Platforms - [IBM](#)